

# CESOP output

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## 1 Main results: vote choice and turnout

This documents presents the main results of the CESOP analysis. Using IBOPE CESOP survey data, I compare respondents just below and just above the age thresholds at which voting switches between voluntary and compulsory—separately for the lower cutpoint (around age 18) and the upper cutpoint (around age 70), and for the state and national surveys. Table 1 reports the share voting for Bolsonaro and Table 2 first-round turnout. Compulsory voting is associated with a higher Bolsonaro vote share at the margin: the difference is statistically significant—by both the t-test and the randomization-inference (ri) p-values—among younger voters in the national surveys (0.27 vs. 0.41) and among older voters in the state surveys (0.46 vs. 0.57), while turnout shows no significant differences across the cutoffs.

Table 1: Difference in the proportion of respondents that voted for Bolsonaro by compulsory voting status

|                  | <b>Lower cutpoint</b><br>(16–17 and 18–19) |                 | <b>Upper cutpoint</b><br>(68–69 and 70–71) |                 |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------------------------|-----------------|
|                  | <i>State</i>                               | <i>National</i> | <i>State</i>                               | <i>National</i> |
| Mean Voluntary   | 0.44                                       | 0.27            | 0.46                                       | 0.46            |
| Mean Compulsory  | 0.43                                       | 0.41            | 0.57                                       | 0.37            |
| p-value (t-test) | 0.85                                       | 0.03            | 0.02                                       | 0.46            |
| p-value (ri)     | 0.86                                       | 0.05            | 0.03                                       | 0.50            |
| N Voluntary      | 235.00                                     | 60.00           | 202.00                                     | 44.00           |
| N Compulsory     | 832.00                                     | 203.00          | 202.00                                     | 35.00           |

Table 2: Difference in the proportion of respondents that turned out to vote in the first round by compulsory voting status

|                  | <b>Lower cutpoint</b><br>(16–17 and 18–19) |                 | <b>Upper cutpoint</b><br>(68–69 and 70–71) |                 |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------------------------|-----------------|
|                  | <i>State</i>                               | <i>National</i> | <i>State</i>                               | <i>National</i> |
| Mean Voluntary   | 0.92                                       | 0.94            | 0.87                                       | 0.85            |
| Mean Compulsory  | 0.95                                       | 0.96            | 0.89                                       | 0.90            |
| p-value (t-test) | 0.11                                       | 0.46            | 0.54                                       | 0.47            |
| p-value (ri)     | 0.09                                       | 0.48            | 0.49                                       | 0.55            |
| N Voluntary      | 255.00                                     | 64.00           | 233.00                                     | 52.00           |
| N Compulsory     | 875.00                                     | 211.00          | 228.00                                     | 39.00           |

## 2 Robustness check

The main pattern is robust to several checks: widening the comparison to a two-year window (Table 3) preserves the significant national result, a placebo test at non-cutoff ages (20/21 and 66/67, Table 4)

shows no significant differences, and the effect persists when demographic controls are added in a regression framework (Table 5).

## 2.1 two-year window

Table 3: Difference in the proportion of respondents that voted for Bolsonaro by compulsory voting status

|                  | Lower cutpoint<br>(16–17 and 18–19) |                 | Upper cutpoint<br>(68–69 and 70–71) |                 |
|------------------|-------------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------|-----------------|
|                  | <i>State</i>                        | <i>National</i> | <i>State</i>                        | <i>National</i> |
| Mean Voluntary   | 0.44                                | 0.23            | 0.49                                | 0.44            |
| Mean Compulsory  | 0.41                                | 0.39            | 0.49                                | 0.40            |
| p-value (t-test) | 0.36                                | 0.00            | 0.99                                | 0.64            |
| p-value (ri)     | 0.38                                | 0.01            | 0.95                                | 0.64            |
| N Voluntary      | 323.00                              | 74.00           | 308.00                              | 78.00           |
| N Compulsory     | 1604.00                             | 383.00          | 484.00                              | 95.00           |

## 2.2 Placebo test

Table 4: Difference in the proportion of respondents that voted for Bolsonaro in the first round between 20–21 and 66–67 olds

|                  | 20 versus 21 year olds |                 | 66 versus 67 year olds |                 |
|------------------|------------------------|-----------------|------------------------|-----------------|
|                  | <i>State</i>           | <i>National</i> | <i>State</i>           | <i>National</i> |
| Mean Voluntary   | 0.04                   | 0.06            | 0.04                   | 0.07            |
| Mean Compulsory  | 0.04                   | 0.07            | 0.04                   | 0.12            |
| p-value (t-test) | 0.81                   | 0.58            | 0.99                   | 0.33            |
| p-value (ri)     | 0.66                   | 0.67            | 0.91                   | 0.36            |
| N Voluntary      | 165.00                 | 155.00          | 56.00                  | 70.00           |
| N Compulsory     | 759.00                 | 221.00          | 254.00                 | 66.00           |

## 2.3 Robustness check by stargazer

Table 5: The effect of compulsory on having voted for Bolsonaro in the first round

|                     | National Surveys    |                     |                     | State Surveys       |                     |                     |
|---------------------|---------------------|---------------------|---------------------|---------------------|---------------------|---------------------|
|                     | All                 | 17-18               | 69-70               | All                 | 17-18               | 69-70               |
| Compulsory Voting   | 0.078<br>(0.052)    | 0.168***<br>(0.060) | −0.179<br>(0.113)   | 0.002<br>(0.029)    | −0.040<br>(0.036)   | 0.105**<br>(0.049)  |
| Constant            | 0.359***<br>(0.055) | 0.248***<br>(0.063) | 0.692***<br>(0.126) | 0.242***<br>(0.075) | 0.248***<br>(0.086) | 0.457***<br>(0.035) |
| Controls            | Yes                 | Yes                 | Yes                 | Yes                 | Yes                 | Yes                 |
| N                   | 342                 | 263                 | 79                  | 1471                | 1067                | 404                 |
| R-squared           | 0.276               | 0.294               | 0.415               | 0.134               | 0.136               | 0.106               |
| Adj. R-squared      | 0.218               | 0.229               | 0.185               | 0.103               | 0.096               | 0.066               |
| Residual Std. Error | 0.432               | 0.427               | 0.448               | 0.472               | 0.471               | 0.483               |
| F Statistic         | 4.811***            | 4.539***            | 1.806**             | 4.382***            | 3.414***            | 2.681***            |

\*\*\*p < .01; \*\*p < .05; \*p < .1

*Note:* All: voluntary/no voluntary (includes a fixed effect by cutpoint), Lower: 16-17/18-19, Upper: 70-71/68-69. The controls included in the regression are: dummy indicators for each level of education, sex, race, catholic, evangelic, party ID (only in national surveys), and survey ID (except for the upper cutpoint in the state surveys, in which there are not enough observations per survey). Robust standard errors are reported.

*Source:* Ibope.